



M/J Music Theory 2

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 6–8 · FULL YEAR

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More musical works are approved for study than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in pieces, topics, and activities from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

M/J Music Theory 2 deepens a scholar's understanding of the structure and logic of Western music. Building on Music Theory 1, intermediate theorists study harmony, chord function, voice leading, form, and analysis within the classical tradition, developing the aural skills that serious musicianship requires. Class work centers on creativity and strengthening analytical ability: scholars compose and arrange short pieces, sight-read, notate music they hear, and critique their own work — applying disciplined reasoning and attentive listening to increasingly sophisticated musical thought. Prerequisite: Music Theory 1.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Harmony and Chord Function (all year)

Major and minor tonalities, chord progressions, and how harmony drives a piece of music.

3 Aural Skills (all year)

Sight-reading standard exercises, playing or singing melodies by ear, and notating rhythms and melodies performed by someone else.

5 Analysis and the Classical Tradition (all year)

Classifying works by period, genre, and style, and tracing how history and technology have shaped composition and performance.

2 Voice Leading and Form (all year)

How musical lines move and how works are built, studied through exemplary pieces of the classical tradition.

4 Composition and Arranging (all year)

Composing short pieces and melodies over standard progressions; arranging by manipulating melody, form, rhythm, and voicing; mixing and editing with software.

6 Critique and Performance (woven through)

Critiquing one's own compositions with guidance, performing expressively from a score — and live performances may extend the learning.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- A theory lesson most days, paired with short aural-skills practice.
- Regular composition and arranging tasks that apply the week's concept immediately.
- Focused listening and analysis of exemplary works from the classical tradition.
- Critique with guidance from the teacher and peers, so each piece improves the next.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Theory, aural practice, and composition work fill most of the scheduled time.
- Composition projects may span more than one week.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- Headphones and a microphone for aural skills and recorded work.
- Staff paper or notation software, as directed in the course.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily on the middle-school schedule.